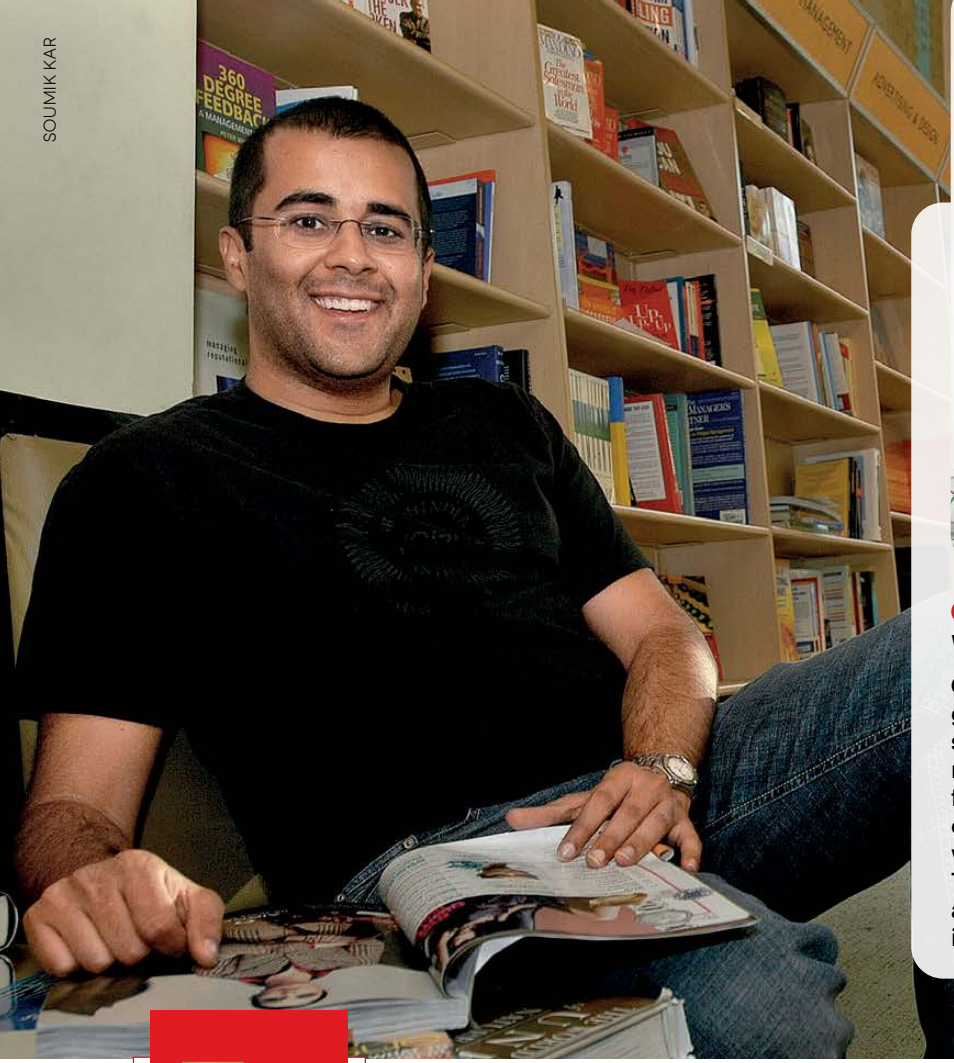
SOUMIK KAR





BIJU GOPAL

WHEN BOOKS WENT MASS

Chetan Bhagat turned English-language fiction into mass consumption, speaking directly to India's aspirational middle class. **Amish Tripathi (above)** followed by repackaging mythology as contemporary popular fiction with enormous commercial success. Together, they democratised reading and made publishing a volume-driven industry rather than an elite pursuit.

50TH ANNIVERSARY
2005-2015

| FAME AND FALL |

SEX, CRIME AND BESTSELLERS

In the decade between 2005 and 2015, India's public conversation was shaped not only by elections, growth curves and street protests but also by books that flew off the shelves, crimes that unsettled middle-class living rooms, and once-revered figures who fell from grace. These years reflected a society in churn, aspirational yet anxious, globally visible yet inwardly conflicted. Cultural success and moral collapse coexisted in the same headlines.

BOOKER COMES HOME, AGAIN

The White Tiger's 2008 Man Booker win marked a sharp counterpoint to celebratory India narratives. **Aravind Adiga**'s dark, unsparing portrait of inequality and corruption forced global readers to confront the costs of growth. The prize reaffirmed Indian fiction's capacity for moral discomfort rather than cultural self-congratulation.

